

All Cleveland, all the time

The Akron men enter MAC Tournament as favorite as entire event will be played at The Q for the first time. Action starts today. Page C4



SPORTS

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Section C

Wednesday, March 7, 2007

CAVALIERS

Tough time to visit old foe

Rick Noland
The Chronicle-Telegram

CLEVELAND — The Cavaliers are catching the Detroit Pistons at a bad time.

When the Eastern Conference and Central Division powers square off tonight at 7:30 at The Palace of Auburn Hills, Detroit will be fresh off an embarrassing 111-93 loss at home to the lowly Golden State Warriors.

It was the previously red-hot Pistons' worst home loss of the season, second-worst overall and just their third defeat in the last 15 games. Ironically, the worst loss of the season also came against the Warriors, who trounced Detroit 111-79 in California.

A proud bunch, the Pistons will likely try to take their frustrations out on the Cavaliers, who were pretty much dominated by their division rival in two games at Quicken Loans Arena this season.

See **CAVS**, C3

INDIANS

Fausto ready to move forward

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

WINTER HAVEN, Fla. — Fausto Carmona dominated Yankees hitters for the first two innings of a 6-5 exhibition victory at Chain of Lakes Park on Tuesday. He struck out three of the seven batters he faced, including Derek Jeter on three pitches.

He looked nothing like the pitcher who finished last year.

A promising 2006 season ended in the most disastrous of ways when Carmona offered up one of the biggest meltdowns in the history of major league closers.

After replacing Bob Wickman, Carmona blew his first three save chances and went 0-5 with an unheard of 16.39 ERA in nine games from July 30 to Aug. 23.

See **FAUSTO**, C6



Carmona

THE TOURNAMENT TRAIL: BOYS

'Horns perfect paint job



JASON MILLER / CHRONICLE

Lutheran West's Dave Mancini is fouled by Clearview's Dash Sokol on Tuesday during the Longhorns' win.

Longhorns' size sinks Clearview

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — Clearview's fourth-quarter challenge was strong enough to convince Lutheran West to get back to its bread-and-butter: the big guys inside.

After the Clippers had chopped a 12-point deficit to one, 46-45, on back-to-back 3-pointers by Matt Chonko and Mike Rosey to start the fourth quarter, the Longhorns used their muscle to pull away in the last 6½ minutes for a 65-58 victory over Clearview in the Division III district semifinals at Elyria High on Tuesday night.

Lutheran West (20-1), which has won 20 games for three straight years, will tangle with an athletic, tough Chanel team here Friday night at 7:30 for the district championship.

"The game is played in spurts," said Longhorn coach Phil Argento. "You can either spurt back or cave (in). Good teams spurt back. It's part of the game."

Lutheran West did it with a high-low post game, one key pick-and-roll and a couple of big baskets by Jacob O'Hara to keep the Clippers at bay. After the back-to-back treys, O'Hara made a steal which resulted in a bucket and free throw.

Troy Simmons' basket got Clearview to within two, 49-47, but 6-foot-6 Andrew Hofener

See **LUTHERAN WEST**, C2

Falls wears down valiant Vermilion

Pete Alpern
The Chronicle-Telegram

WESTLAKE — In many ways, the Olmsted Falls Bulldogs and the Vermilion Sailors are two teams cut from the same cloth. They feature two of the area's most athletic rosters and utilize that speed and length to create full-court chaos over four quarters.

But the differences that emerged when the two went head to head on Tuesday were unmistakable. Olmsted Falls established a frenetic pace early and coupled it with a grueling physical defense in the paint.

By midway through the fourth quarter, the Sailors were gassed physically and mentally. Behind 23 points from Tyler Sparks and some timely perimeter shooting off the bench, the Bulldogs won 71-46 in a Division II district semifinal at Westlake High School.

Olmsted Falls (20-2 overall) now turns its attention to the other side of the bracket. It will face the winner of tonight's Rocky River-

See **FALLS**, C2

INSIDE
CLOSE, BUT NO CIGAR: Oberlin knocked out of Division IV tournament, 62-59 by Mapleton. **C2**

COLLEGE BASKETBALL

Jackson's come a long way

Ex-Saints star set to complete stellar career at Gannon

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — Hop in the car and drive to Erie, Pa. Good four-lane roads most of the way. Takes a couple of hours, 120 miles and change. Nothing to it.

It's a longer, perhaps less accommodating trip from the gyms and asphalt playgrounds of South Lorain to stardom on the gleaming hardwood courts



Jackson

Lorain County Miss Basketball that year, is wrapping up her college career at Erie's Gannon University in the Division II spotlight.

On Thursday, she was named the Great Lakes Intercollegiate

Athletic Conference player of the year, the first Gannon women's player to win the honor. In addition, the 6-foot post was selected most valuable player of the GLIAC Tournament, which Gannon won, 88-77, over Hillsdale on Saturday.

Jackson and the Lady Knights leave today for suburban Chicago and the NCAA Division II Great Lakes regional tournament. Sixth-seeded Gannon (21-5) meets third-seeded Grand Valley State at 1 p.m. Friday on the campus of host

See **JACKSON**, C5

Christina Jackson puts up a shot this season as she leads Gannon University. Jackson, Lorain County Miss Basketball in 2003, totaled 1,000 points and 1,000 rebounds in her college career that is nearing an end.



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